

Tiago Cabaço

tiago.cabaco@gmail.com

tiagocabaco.me

+65 8783 1663

linkedin.com/in/tiagocabaco

SUMMARY

I'm a product and design leader with 20 years of experience leading teams that are identifying the right people problems and crafting user-centered, value-add solutions across a diverse number of paradigms, from SuperApps, to marketplaces, social media, e-commerce, mobility, fintech, as well as advertising and branding.

Experienced in scaling design teams globally, from small (2-8) to large (80+), in their multi-disciplinary setup across product design, UX research/insights, writing/content, and creatives/illustration.

I have worked, or led teams, in places such as San Francisco Bay Area, Argentina, Portugal, Germany, Poland, India, UAE and most recently APAC -- I'm passionate about immersing in new cultures and understanding how others solve problems, just as much as I hope to be able to influence, inspire and contribute to the growth of those around me.

EXPERIENCE

Delivery Hero / VP of Design

MAY 2023 - PRESENT

As VP of Design at Delivery Hero, I lead the UX team within the Pandora Product & Tech organization, and its amazing team of Product Designers, UX Researchers and Pandora's Design System. My role involves driving strategic initiatives, enhancing team dynamics, and ensuring our UX practices contribute significantly to the growth and success of the three brands that Pandora enables: foodpanda, foodora and Yemeksepeti. Some key contributions to date:

- Championed a culture that values both outcomes and craft, encouraging teams to challenge conventions, sweat the details, evolve our design system, and continuously raise the quality of the experiences we ship to millions of users;
- Transformed the design team's scope into a key driver of product strategy by revitalising product discovery and empowering teams to identify opportunities, define solutions and shape experiments. This contributed over €100M incremental GMV impact in the first 12 months and led to design-led initiatives representing more than 70% of Pandora's product roadmap the following year;
- Demonstrated ability to dive deep into critical projects needing hands-on support. Provided direct involvement and leadership in projects, leading to their successful execution and rollout;
- Enhanced the strategic reliance on UX by amplifying the team's voice and integrating UX leaders into product directions. Identified and resolved issues in individual and team dynamics, improving internal team relationships and establishing a better working model for certain product tribes and domains;
- Identified opportunities to drive transformative initiatives that set new strategic directions for the teams and the Pandora organization. Led efforts to reinvigorate the team with innovative paths, resulting in user-tested designs and compelling business cases;
- Responsibly *infusing* AI into our UX practices, driving demonstrable workflow improvements while evolving the team's capabilities from general awareness to leveraging AI as architects and strategists. Spearheaded the introduction of agentic design into our process to reshape both our internal workflows and the product experience.

Careem (an Uber company) / VP of Design

SEP 2020 - MAY 2023

Responsible for the holistic experience of our SuperApp, and its 4 main customer segments: Consumers (the end user of the app), Partners (restaurants, shops, etc), 3rd party tenants (that feed the SuperApp flywheel and help us enrich the offering with new services), and last but not least our Captains (our drivers and delivery workforce, without whom we wouldn't exist). Each of these segments has corresponding lines of business where my team is embedded.

Some of the achievements:

- Grew the team from ~8 designers to ~40 in less than 24 months. Crafting the plan, finding gaps in workforce planning, budget planning, defining hiring strategy, etc, as well as instilling a distributed hiring setup given how difficult it is to hire in region – design is now a fully distributed organisation at Careem
- Established foundational team artifacts, from onboarding, hiring

- frameworks to career ladders and competencies, and many others
- Facilitated the definition of the team's purpose, mission and principles that are used as the guardrails and guiding force for the team today
- Have successfully introduced (hired) and embedded the practice of UX Research as a leading discipline of our product discovery processes, de-risking future investment and increasing the confidence in decision making of the strategies and roadmaps we set out to accomplish
- Have introduced (hired) and embedded the practices of UX Writing and Illustration/Creative into the design team in an effort to humanize our experiences, make them more personable and more aligned with our brand direction and values
- Established a centralised design system team from scratch, in a healthy triad between product, design and engineering. Beyond the development, implementation and championing of the design system, the team is also responsible for considerable efficiencies in productivity and speed of the teams on the ground
- Positioned design as a forward thinking discipline by identifying clear customer and business opportunities, defining hypothesis off of them, and conceptualizing what the future of Careem, in specific areas, could look and feel like – these pieces of work are the north star today for the product streams where we applied them, and roadmaps are stemmed from those visions: SuperApp, Loyalty Programme, Food Delivery and Careem Pay (our fintech offering), etc
- Co-leading rebranding efforts for Careem (launch in 2023)

OLX Group / Global Director of Product Design & Research

SEP 2018 - SEP 2020

The Global Product Design & Research team was a newly formed organisation within the larger OLX Group that was looking to help shape and transform how we identified real customer problems, and looked to create meaningful and impactful solutions that delivered value back to our customers. Focused on putting the right processes in place to bring, and elevate the voice of the customer into everything we did, not only in our product, but as a business as well. Whether creating new products, or helping business teams and others gain a deeper understanding of our customers, people at the Product Design & Research team are problem solvers at heart.

- 60+ Product Designers and UX Researchers strong (~50% growth in 12 mo);
- Team spanning across multiple tech hubs (Lisbon, Berlin, Poznan, Gurgaon, Buenos Aires) and multiple product streams (Motors, Real Estate, as well as Jobs, Goods and Services under OLX EU and OLX Emerging Markets)
- Strong focus on people, org efficiencies, standards, systems that allow the team, globally, to speak a common (design) language;
- Elevating design and research to a thought partnership role with product, technology and business leaders—having the proverbial seat at the table;
- Spearheading a transformation towards a more customer centric way of working by solidifying the role of Product Design and UX Research as disciplines deeply embedded in our product development teams and cycles, and in how we lead collaboration and co-creation cross-functionally, not only with Product & Tech teams, but with market/business teams alike;
- Beginning to instil the practice of UX Writing and Design Ops;

- In charge of the rebranding and redesign efforts for the OLX product globally;
- Leading the efforts of a new mobile offering for our OLX EU product;

The OLX Group is a global product and tech company with 17 brands, +40 countries, +5000 people and one mindset—make it super easy for people to buy and sell almost anything, boosting local economies.

Uniplaces / VP of Product

OCT 2016 - SEP 2018, Lisbon, Portugal

Led a team of 50+, composed of product managers, product designers, UX Researchers, engineers and Data scientists in putting the right processes in place to make constant quality product improvements part of our DNA.

Responsible for the product vision, strategy and roadmap, as well as overseeing its conception and development in a design and customer oriented way:

- Instilled UX Research practice
- Strengthened Product Design team and discipline
- Built the groundwork for a responsible product development process (basic premise around: discovery, exploration, confirmation, repeat)
- Grew engagement satisfaction by working on topics such as culture, L&D and pay gaps
- Part of the LT team in helping shape strategy and direction for business, along with C-level peers

Facebook / Product Design Lead

APR 2014 - MAR 2017, Menlo Park, California, USA

Led the Design efforts on the Applied Machine Learning group. We worked with a series of AI-powered technologies, from speech reco, conversational understanding, translation, computational photography, to virtual and augmented reality, and others. My team's focus was to identify and remove the inherent complexities and novelties of these technologies, into sensible and impactful product experiences that reached and influenced the lives of over 1.5 Billion people.

Gyft / Head of Design

JAN 2014 - APR 2014, Redwood City, California, USA

At Gyft I led a design team of three tackling all fronts, from branding to product experience. Mobile (iOS and Android apps), Web (Website and Web App) and any marketing or company collateral (templating e-mail communication, banners, etc, as well as pitch decks, etc).

In the time I was there I managed to:

- Grow the team;
- Revamp the entire Gyft mobile and desktop apps;

- Built a gift card management system to embed/install in POSs;
- Created Marketing collateral including Transactional and Marketing comms;
- Instilled a customer centric mindset to product management and design.

Nuance Communications / Product Design Lead

JAN 2011 - JAN 2014, Sunnyvale, California, USA

Product Design Lead on the Strategy, Design and Innovation team. In charge of the UX, UI and Visual Design for Nuance's products across different business units. Its products include Nuance's TV and Automotive reference applications, as well as a number of engagements with Enterprise, Healthcare and consumer products. Delivering solutions across a number of channels and devices, from Smart TV Interfaces, to defining in-car infotainment systems and designing web applications, as well as design for mobile (iOS and Android). Pioneering innovative best practices around designing the presentation layer of a speech interface and how it relates to the overall User Experience and GUI. Co-developing concepts such as Transmodal Design and using a virtual persona to engage the user and enrich the holistic experience.

EDUCATION

Academy of Art University / BFA, Design & New Media

San Francisco, California, USA

3.9 GPA, Multiple awards, including **Adobe Design Achievement Award**

PATENTS

Virtual Assistant Development System

US 20160062604 · Issued Mar 3, 2016US 20160062604 · Issued Mar 3, 2016

In accordance with aspects of the disclosure, a computing device may provide a user interface for developing an interactive natural-language response system, which may include a virtual assistant. A user may interact with a system using spoken, written (e.g., text), or other input methods. The user interface may allow a user to associate sentences with intents, tag words within the sentences with concepts, and construct a grammar using the associated intents and tagged concepts. The system may use the grammar for automatically predictively associating sentences with intents and words with concepts. The system may display in the form of a chat transcript a single branch of a tree of a discussion between the virtual assistant and a user. The user interface may graphically display variable values to assist a user to test system responses under different simulated conditions.

System and Methods for Providing a Voice Agent Interface

US 13/632344 · Filed Oct 1, 2012US 13/632344 · Filed Oct 1, 2012

Interactive Voicemail System

US 13-0040-WO-ORG